MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 11

"If You Don't Know Me by Now"

Episode 2x11. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x11. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Friday, December 9, 2005 (first snowstorm of the winter), 5:18 AM through 11:57 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x10

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Friday, December 9, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, December 9, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Tanya Harrell (new)	Patient: Rikers detainee, swallowed foreign bodies	May 3, 1976	29
Officer Annette Biggs	NYC Corrections Officer; Jermaine's mother	Nov 3, 1953	52
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern (26 since December 3)	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern (Step 2 CK retake Monday)	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (31 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (on probation)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Darius 'Dash' Duvall (debut)	Patient: dilated cardiomyopathy, Status 1A	Aug 8, 1971	34
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Tamika Wardell (new)	Patient: quintuplets at 29w2d, abruption	Sep 14, 1974	31
Andre Wardell (new)	Tamika's husband; accountant	Mar 27, 1972	33
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53
Howard Divine	Harmony's father	Aug 30, 1950	55
Jerome 'Jerry' and Ronald 'Ronnie' Divine	Harmony's twin brothers	May 5, 1972	33
Mercy (new)	A brindle pit bull puppy, about 10 weeks old	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: a GI attending, a NICU attending, NICU nurses and fellows, an L&D; nurse, a step-down night nurse, a snow-day wrist-fracture patient, and the Wardell quintuplets: Aaliyah (A),

Andre Jr. (B), Brielle (C), Devin (D) and Elijah (E). Mentioned: Kiara Harrell (6), Corinne Smilley, Malcolm Sloan, Alicia Monroe and Big Ray's dog Biscuit.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. RIKERS ISLAND - ROSE M. SINGER CENTER - PUNITIVE SEGREGATION - PRE-DAWN
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:18 AM

A concrete cell, six by eight feet. A steel bunk, a steel toilet, a slot in the door. Fluorescent light that never goes off. TANYA HARRELL (29), in an orange jumpsuit, sits on the bunk with a TV remote she has pried open. Two AA batteries lie in her palm. She looks at them for a long time.

She puts the first one in her mouth and swallows. Then the second. Then she breaks the plastic clip off a ballpoint pen and swallows that too. She lies down on the bunk and folds her hands on her stomach, almost peaceful.

The slot in the door opens. Corrections Officer ANNETTE BIGGS (52) looks in, then looks again.

OFFICER BIGGS
(sharp)
Harrell. (beat) Harrell, what's in your hand?

TANYA
(to the ceiling, calm)
Nothing anymore, C.O.

MARC (V.O.)
Doctors are supposed to know people.

2 EXT. HUNTERS POINT - 49TH AVENUE - DAWN
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:55 AM

Snow. The first real snow of the winter, falling thick and silent on the brownstones of 49th Avenue, on parked cars, on the Pepsi-Cola sign across the water. The street is white and untouched. In an upstairs window of the House, a light comes on.

MARC (V.O.)
We take a history. We ask where it hurts, how long, how bad. (beat) We think that if we ask the right questions, we'll know who's in the bed.

Inside, Marc (26) stands at his bedroom window in a Howard T-shirt, watching the snow come down over Manhattan.

MARC (V.O.)
But you can know everything about a person's body and nothing at all about the person.

Down the hall, a door opens. Raven (26), in her bonnet, pads past his doorway, sees the window and stops.

RAVEN
(whispering, delighted)
Snow.

MARC
(beat)
Snow.

MARC (V.O.)
And some people spend their whole lives waiting for somebody to ask the right question.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:07 AM

The kitchen. On the counter, the last slice of a red velvet cake from Make My Cake sits under plastic wrap. A "HAPPY 26TH RAVEN" banner, half fallen, still hangs above the window. Harmony (26) stirs grits. Amond (26) eats toast standing up. Arianna (26), who slept over, sits at the table with a review book, her flashcards in rubber-banded stacks.

AMOND
(reading the NY1 crawl on the counter TV)
"Six to eight inches by tonight." (beat) The 7 train will be fine. The 7 train is always fine. (beat) The 7 train is a lie.

RAVEN
(coming in, pouring coffee)
You said that about the 7 train during the hurricane.

AMOND
And I was right during the hurricane.

Harmony's phone sits face up on the counter next to the grits. She keeps glancing at it.

RAVEN
(gently)
Jamaica Hospital?

HARMONY
(stirring)
They read Daddy's CT yesterday afternoon. (beat) His doctor's going to call with the result today. (beat) "Today." (beat) Like a day is a time.

ARIANNA
(not looking up)
Did they say "call" or "come in"?

HARMONY
(beat)
"Call."

ARIANNA
(turning a page)
Call is good. (beat) Come in is bad. (beat) Nobody tells you cancer on the phone.

Harmony looks at her. Arianna looks up and shrugs.

ARIANNA
(beat)
My mother's psychiatrist called with good news and made us come in for bad news. (beat) Fifteen years. It was never wrong.

HARMONY
(beat, quietly)
Thank you, Problem.

ARIANNA
(back to the book)
Don't. (beat) Three days. Renal. I'm busy.

4 EXT. VERNON BOULEVARD - JACKSON AVENUE - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:34 AM

Snow piles up on the sidewalk. Marc, in a peacoat and a Howard scarf, comes up out of the Vernon Boulevard-Jackson Avenue station stairs into the storm. At the top of the stairs, stamping snow off her boots, is Esther (26), just off the 7 from the G transfer.

ESTHER
(beat)
Two trains and a shuttle bus from Brooklyn Heights. (beat) I'm moving to Queens.

MARC
(beat)
Don't.

They walk together toward the hospital, past Monty's, the bar's windows dark. Esther stops.

ESTHER
Did you hear that?

A tiny, thin whimper, from beside the dumpster in Monty's alley. Marc crouches. In a soggy cardboard box under the dumpster's lip, half buried in snow: a brindle pit bull puppy, maybe ten weeks old, shivering so hard its teeth click. No collar. One ear up, one ear down.

MARC
(softly)
Hey. (beat) Hey, little girl.

ESTHER
(kneeling beside him)
She's freezing. (beat) Her gums are pale.

Marc unbuttons his peacoat, scoops the puppy up and tucks her against his chest. The puppy burrows in and goes still. Esther tucks her own scarf around the puppy's head.

ESTHER
(beat)
Marc. You can't take a dog to work.

MARC
(beat, already walking)
I'm not taking a dog to work. (beat) I'm taking a patient to the ER.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SECURITY OFFICE - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:49 AM

Big Ray Toles (45) sits behind his desk with a coffee and a wall of security monitors. Marc stands in front of him, his coat open. The puppy's head pokes out, wrapped in Esther's scarf. Esther stands behind Marc, trying not to laugh.

BIG RAY
(beat)
No.

MARC
Ray.

BIG RAY
Dr. Bullock. (beat) This is a hospital. (beat) There's a Joint Commission. (beat) You personally brought the Joint Commission.

MARC
(beat)
She was in the snow behind Monty's. She's ten weeks old. She'd have been dead by noon. (beat) Twelve hours. In a box. In your office. With the space heater.

The puppy yawns enormously and licks Big Ray's hand. Big Ray looks down at the puppy. The puppy looks up at Big Ray.

BIG RAY
(beat, heavily)
My daughter had a pit bull. (beat) Named him Biscuit. (beat) Ate my good shoes for three years. (beat) I cried like a baby when he died.

ESTHER
(beat)
Is that a yes?

BIG RAY
(taking the puppy, gruff)
It's a "she stays in the box, and the box stays under my desk, and if Dr. Donohue asks, I have never seen a dog in my life."

He settles the puppy into an empty paper box with a towel, by the space heater. She curls up and falls asleep instantly.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:03 AM

Elxa (28), thirty-one weeks pregnant, her scrub top now a maternity scrub top, sits on her stool, feet on the glove box. The interns gather: Marc, Esther, Raven, Amond, Harmony, Arianna and Kennerly (27).

ELXA
Snow day. Half the nurses are stuck on the Van Wyck. (beat) Every fall, every fender-bender in Queens is coming through those doors. (beat) Nobody goes home early. Nobody gets cute.

ELXA
(reading off)
Baker, Kennerly: Lowery, general. Rikers is sending us a GI foreign body. (beat) Ellison: Cardio step-down, Dr. Robert Bullock, transplant patient. (beat) Divine: Ortho, the snow is about to break hips all over Queens. (beat) Smilley: Neuro, Graves. Cummings: with me. (beat) Bullock. (beat) Crump. Peds.

MARC
(beat)
Peds?

ELXA
(beat)
L&D has a woman at twenty-nine weeks with quintuplets. (beat) If those babies come today, Dr. Crump wants every pair of hands he can get, and I'm not allowed to give him mine without giving him yours. (beat) You'll be on the neonatal side. (beat) Not obstetrics. (beat) The firewall holds.

A ripple around the group. Quintuplets.

RAVEN
(beat, under her breath)
Five.

ELXA
(standing, a hand on her own belly)
I can barely carry one. (beat) Go.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 2 - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:24 AM

Tanya Harrell, handcuffed by one wrist to the gurney rail, in an orange jumpsuit, lies looking at the ceiling. Officer Annette Biggs stands at the foot of the gurney in her uniform. Lowery (58), Amond and Kennerly study an abdominal X-ray on the light box: two small, bright cylinders in the stomach, and a sliver of plastic further down.

LOWERY
Two AA batteries and a plastic pen clip. (beat) Swallowed at about five-fifteen.

AMOND
(flat)
Both batteries are still in the stomach. Endoscopic retrieval. Twenty minutes. (beat) Then she goes back.

TANYA
(to the ceiling)
Not if I can help it.

Amond turns. Tanya smiles at him, thin and tired.

AMOND
(beat)
Ms. Harrell, button batteries burn through the esophagus in two hours. These are cylinders. (beat) You'll be fine.

TANYA
(beat)
I know, Doctor. (beat) I looked it up in the law library. AA's were the safest thing in the cell.

KENNERLY
(beat)
You planned this.

TANYA
(beat)
Three weeks.

AMOND
(coolly, writing)
Then you planned to take an operating room, a gastroenterologist and two surgical interns away from people who didn't do this to themselves.

A beat. Officer Biggs glances at Amond, then at Tanya.

OFFICER BIGGS
(quietly)
She's been in the Bing seven months, Doctor.

AMOND
(not looking up)
The what?

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
Punitive segregation. (beat) Solitary. (beat) Twenty-three hours a day in that cell. (beat) One hour in a cage outside. (beat) Seven months.

Amond pauses for a fraction of a second. Then he keeps writing.

AMOND
(beat)
Endoscopy at eight-thirty.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:41 AM

DARIUS "DASH" DUVALL (34), lean, handsome, with a gap-toothed grin and two-day stubble, lies propped up in bed in a Carolina blue hoodie, a PICC line running milrinone into his arm. On the windowsill: a row of brand-new limited-edition sneakers in their boxes, like trophies. Robert (49) reviews the chart. Raven stands beside him.

ROBERT
Mr. Duvall. Thirty-four. Idiopathic dilated cardiomyopathy. Ejection fraction fifteen percent. (beat) Status 1A on the transplant list since November eleventh, on continuous milrinone. (beat) Dr. Ellison will be following you.

DASH
(looking at Raven, grinning)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) Are you the one who does hair?

RAVEN
(startled)
How do you...

DASH
The night nurse. (beat) She said there's an intern who did a forty-one-pound tumor lady's hair before church. (beat) Look at me. (beat) I haven't had a line-up since Thanksgiving. I look like a man with a heart condition.

RAVEN
(beat, laughing despite herself)
You are a man with a heart condition.

DASH
(beat)
I own two sneaker stores in Charlotte, Doctor. (beat) I've got a reputation.

Robert closes the chart.

ROBERT
(dry)
Mr. Duvall, your heart is the size of a cantaloupe and it pumps like a garden hose with a kink in it. (beat) Your reputation can wait.

DASH
(beat, to Raven, sotto)
He's fun.

ROBERT
(beat, to Raven)
Vitals every two hours, daily weights, strict ins and outs. (beat) If his pressure drops below ninety, you page me. (beat) If he asks you out, you page me.

DASH
(calling after him as he leaves)
I would never, Dr. Bullock.

Robert is gone. Dash turns to Raven and lowers his voice.

DASH
(beat, serious for a moment)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) Real question. (beat) How long does a 1A wait in New York?

RAVEN
(beat, honest)
It depends on your blood type and your size. (beat) Weeks. Sometimes months.

DASH
(beat, the grin coming back)
Then I'd better get that line-up.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 3 - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 8:06 AM

TAMIKA WARDELL (31), a third-grade teacher, lies on her side, impossibly huge, five fetal monitors strapped around her belly. Her husband, ANDRE WARDELL (33), an accountant in a Fordham sweatshirt, holds her hand. Clayton (34) studies five tracings on the screen. Crump (61), bow tie, stands with Marc.

CLAYTON
(calm)
Twenty-nine weeks, two days. Contractions every six minutes since four a.m. (beat) Magnesium for neuroprotection. Betamethasone was given Tuesday. (beat) We're trying to buy these babies a few more days.

TAMIKA
(barely)
Five days. (beat) Can you buy them five days?

CLAYTON
(gently)
I'm going to try, Mrs. Wardell.

CRUMP
(to Marc, low, by the door)
Five babies at twenty-nine weeks, Dr. Bullock. (beat) Average weight maybe two and a half pounds. (beat) That means five neonatal teams, five warmers, and five sets of hands that don't shake.

Tamika looks over at Marc and Crump.

TAMIKA
(beat)
Are you the baby doctors?

CRUMP
(bowing slightly)
We are, young lady.

TAMIKA
(beat, tears starting)
The fertility doctor said we should reduce. (beat) At twelve weeks. Take two of them out so the other three would have a better chance. (beat) I said no. (beat) I said God gave me five. (beat) If anything happens to any of them, it's because I said no.

ANDRE
(squeezing her hand)
Mika.

CRUMP
(beat, gently)
Young lady. (beat) Nothing that happens today is going to be because you loved them too much.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 8:47 AM

Natasha (47) at her desk, the snow piling up on the windowsill. A knock. Whitlow (56) stands in the doorway without his tea. He looks older than he did a week ago.

NATASHA
(beat)
Horace.

WHITLOW
(stiffly)
The Evidence of Standards Compliance is due January fifteenth. (beat) Medication reconciliation. (beat) A form at admission, pharmacist review within twenty-four hours, reconciliation at every transfer and at discharge.

NATASHA
(beat)
That sounds like a good plan.

WHITLOW
(beat)
My residents will have to be trained. (beat) Forty-one of them, in five weeks. (beat) I'd like a surgeon to present the Tate case at Medicine Grand Rounds on the twentieth. (beat) The one who caught it.

Natasha looks at him for a long moment.

NATASHA
(beat)
You want Amond Baker to stand in front of your entire department and tell them what they missed.

WHITLOW
(beat, quietly)
I want them to hear it from someone who isn't me. (beat) They don't listen to me this month, Natasha. (beat) I imagine you understand why.

NATASHA
(beat)
I'll ask Dr. Baker. (beat) If he says yes, it's because he wants to. Not because I asked.

WHITLOW
(beat, turning to go)
Of course. (beat) Nothing in this hospital ever happens because you asked.

He's gone. Natasha looks at the door, unsure whether that was an insult or a white flag.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 3 - MORNING
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:14 AM

Alarms. Tamika gasps, clutching her belly. Bright red blood spreads across the sheet. On the monitors, one of the five tracings plunges. The nurse slams the call button.

CLAYTON
(instantly)
Abruption. (beat) Baby A's heart rate is sixty. (beat) We're going. (beat) Call a crash section, OR 2. (beat) Call NICU, five teams, now. Five.

TAMIKA
(screaming)
No, no, it's too early, it's too early!

ANDRE
(panicked)
What's happening? What's happening?

CLAYTON
(unlocking the bed, already rolling)
The placenta's pulling away, Mr. Wardell. (beat) Your babies are coming now.

Marc grabs the phone on the wall.

MARC
(into the phone)
NICU. This is Bullock with Dr. Crump. Five neonates, twenty-nine weeks, crash section in OR 2. (beat) Five warmers. Five teams. Two minutes.

The bed hurtles out the door. Andre runs beside it, holding Tamika's hand until a nurse stops him at the red

line. He stands there in the hallway, alone, as the doors swing shut.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:21 AM

Controlled chaos. Five radiant warmers line the wall, labeled A through E in black marker on tape. At each warmer, a neonatal team: Crump at A, Elxa at B with Arianna, NICU fellows at C and D, and Marc at E with a NICU nurse. Clayton, gowned, makes the incision. Tamika is under general anesthesia.

CLAYTON
(fast)
Uterus open. (beat) Baby A.
(beat) Girl. Floppy.

A tiny gray infant, smaller than a hand, is passed to Crump's warmer. Crump starts positive pressure ventilation with a mask the size of a thimble.

CLAYTON
Baby B. Boy. (beat) Crying.

A thin, angry wail. Elxa catches him. Arianna dries and stimulates.

CLAYTON
Baby C. Girl. (beat) Baby D. Boy.
(beat) Baby E. (beat) Boy. (beat)
Small.

The last baby comes out and is passed to Marc. He is astonishingly small: a pound and a half, translucent skin, no tone, no breath. Marc lays him on the warmer and dries him. Nothing.

MARC
(calm, fast)
Baby E. No respiratory effort.
Heart rate... (beat, listening)
Fifty. (beat) Bag him.

The NICU nurse squeezes the tiny bag. The chest doesn't rise.

NICU NURSE
No chest rise.

MARC
(repositioning the mask)
Reposition. Open the mouth. Increase pressure. (beat) Tube. Two-point-five.

He takes the laryngoscope. The blade is like a toy. He slides it in, lifts, sees the cords, a slit the width of a pencil lead, and passes a tube thinner than a coffee stirrer.

MARC
(beat)
I'm in.

The nurse bags. The chest rises. Marc listens.

MARC
(beat)
Heart rate eighty. (beat) Ninety. (beat) Surfactant.

Across the room, Crump looks over from Baby A, who has pinked up, and meets Marc's eyes for a split second.

CRUMP
(calm)
Report, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(squeezing surfactant down the tube)
Baby E, intubated, heart rate a hundred and ten, surfactant in. (beat) Seven hundred grams, maybe less.

CRUMP
(beat)
Then let's get them all upstairs.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ENDOSCOPY SUITE - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:58 AM

Tanya, sedated, on her side. The gastroenterologist steers the scope. On the monitor: the stomach lining, and one AA battery resting in a fold. A wire basket opens around it and draws it up and out. Amond and Kennerly watch. Lowery reviews a new X-ray on the viewing box.

GI ATTENDING
(pulling the scope)
One battery. (beat) Where's the other one?

Lowery taps the X-ray. A bright cylinder sits in the right lower abdomen, along with the pen clip.

LOWERY
(beat)
The second battery passed the pylorus before she got here. (beat) It's in the distal ileum, near the valve. (beat) The pen clip's beside it.

AMOND
(beat)
It'll pass.

LOWERY
Probably. (beat) Serial films every six hours. (beat) If it stops moving, if she gets a fever, if her belly changes, we go in.

KENNERLY
(quietly, to Amond)
You really hate her, huh?

AMOND
(beat, peeling off his gloves)
I don't hate her. (beat) I don't think about her. (beat) There are five babies upstairs who didn't swallow anything.

Kennerly looks at Amond for a beat.

KENNERLY
(beat)
You know I was on probation for not giving a damn about a patient's family, right? (beat) Just checking which side of that line you want to be on.

Amond stops. Then he walks out without answering.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:32 AM

Dash sits up in bed with a towel around his shoulders. Raven stands behind him with a pair of clippers she borrowed from the barber in the hospital lobby, carefully edging his hairline. His milrinone pump clicks quietly.

DASH
(eyes closed, blissful)
Oh, that's it. (beat) That's it right there.

RAVEN
(concentrating)
Hold still. (beat) If I mess up your line, you'll have a crooked part when they bring you a heart.

DASH
(beat)
They bring you a heart, you don't care about your part.

RAVEN
(beat, smiling)
You'd care.

DASH
(beat)
Yeah. I'd care.

Raven brushes the clippings off his neck. He opens his eyes and looks at her in the hand mirror she holds up.

DASH
(beat)
There he is. (beat) That's Dash Duvall. (beat) I'd forgotten what he looked like.

RAVEN
(beat)
What was he like? Before?

DASH
(beat, still looking in the mirror)
Loud. (beat) Stayed up too late. Danced at weddings he wasn't invited to. (beat) Came to New York for a sneaker convention at the Javits Center in October and fainted face-first into a limited-edition display. (beat) Woke up in your ICU. (beat) Never made it home.

Raven sets the mirror down. Her hand rests on his shoulder a beat too long. Dash notices.

DASH
(softly)
Dr. Ellison.

RAVEN
(taking her hand away)
Vitals in two hours, Mr. Duvall.

DASH
(beat, grinning)
Dash.

RAVEN
(at the door, not turning around)
Vitals in two hours, Dash.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:09 AM

Five isolettes in a row, labeled with pink and blue cards: WARDELL A, B, C, D, E. Monitors beep. Ventilators hiss. Crump moves from isolette to isolette with a NICU attending. Marc stands at E, watching a monitor. Elxa, at B, leans against the wall, a hand on her own belly, breathing carefully.

CRUMP
(reviewing)
A, eleven hundred grams, on CPAP. B, twelve hundred, crying at us, God bless him. C, a thousand. (beat) D, nine-fifty, with a gastroschisis. His bowel's outside his belly. We'll silo him this afternoon. (beat) E...

MARC
(quietly)
Six hundred and eighty grams. (beat) His head ultrasound shows a grade four bleed on the left. (beat) Grade three on the right.

Crump comes to stand beside him. They look at the tiny boy in the isolette, his chest moving with each puff of the ventilator.

CRUMP
(beat)
Do you know what that means, Dr. Bullock?

MARC
(beat)
It means even if he lives, he probably won't walk. (beat) Or see. (beat) Or know who his mother is.

CRUMP
(gently)
It means we keep him comfortable and we tell his parents the truth. (beat) Gently. (beat) Today.

Marc looks at the baby.

MARC
(beat)
Can I be the one who tells them?

CRUMP
(beat, studying him)
Why?

MARC
(beat)
Because I put the tube in. (beat) Because if I'm the one who kept him alive, I should be the one who tells them how much.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:38 AM

Arianna on the bottom bunk with flashcards. Raven comes in, flushed, and sits on the edge of the bunk. She can't stop smiling.

ARIANNA
(not looking up)
What.

RAVEN
Nothing.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You're smiling like you just found twenty dollars in a coat.

RAVEN
(beat)
I gave a patient a line-up.

ARIANNA
(looking up now)
A patient.

RAVEN
(beat)
Cardio. (beat) Transplant list. (beat) He's funny. He hadn't had a haircut since Thanksgiving.

Arianna puts down the cards.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What's his name?

RAVEN
(beat)
Darius Duvall. (beat) Dash.

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
Dash.

RAVEN
He's a patient, Problem.

ARIANNA
(picking up the cards again)
Then why'd you say his nickname like it was a song?

Raven opens her mouth and doesn't answer. Arianna flips a card without reading it.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - CAST ROOM - DAY

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:02 PM

Snow-day carnage: three wrist fractures waiting on chairs in the hall. Harmony wraps a plaster splint on an elderly man's wrist. Camille (29) reads films at the light box. Harmony's phone buzzes in her pocket. She freezes.

CAMILLE
(without turning)
Answer it, Choir.

Harmony fumbles the phone out with plaster-covered fingers.

HARMONY
(into the phone)
This is Dr. Divine. (beat) Yes. (beat) Yes, I'm his daughter. (beat) I'm a doctor. You can tell me the numbers.

She listens. Camille turns from the light box and watches her face.

HARMONY
(beat)
Six millimeters. (beat) Solid. Smooth margins. (beat) No lymph nodes. (beat) Same size as the X-ray in September. (beat) Repeat CT in six months. (beat) June. (beat) Thank you. (beat) Thank you, Doctor.

She hangs up. She stands very still, plaster on her hands.

HARMONY
(barely)
It's the same size. (beat) Three months and it didn't grow. (beat) They want to look again in June.

CAMILLE
(beat)
That's good, Choir.

HARMONY
(beat, her voice cracking)
It's not "it's nothing." (beat)
It's "come back in June."

CAMILLE
(crossing to her)
It's "come back in June," baby.
(beat) That means there's a June.

Harmony laughs, a wet, startled laugh, and Camille hugs her, plaster and all. The old man with the splinted wrist looks on approvingly.

OLD MAN
(beat)
Good news?

HARMONY
(into Camille's shoulder)
My daddy's got a June.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL WARD - ROOM 418 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:47 PM

Tanya, handcuffed to the bed rail, curled on her side, sweating. Officer Biggs stands by the window. Amond comes in with the afternoon films and stops. Tanya's face is gray. She's breathing fast.

AMOND
(beat)
Ms. Harrell.

TANYA
(through her teeth)
It's nothing.

Amond puts a hand on her belly. She screams. The belly is rigid, like a board.

AMOND
(beat, sharp, to the nurse in the hall)
Vitals. Now. (beat) Page Dr. Lowery.

NURSE
(reading the monitor)
One-oh-two-point-four. (beat) Heart rate one-thirty.

Amond holds the new X-ray up to the window light. The battery and the pen clip haven't moved. Beneath the diaphragm, a crescent of black air.

AMOND
(quietly)
Free air. (beat) The pen clip perforated the bowel.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
Is she going to die?

AMOND
(beat, already moving)
Not if we're fast. (beat) Uncuff her. She's going to the OR.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
I can't uncuff her, Doctor. Regulations.

AMOND
(turning on her)
Then you're going to scrub in, Officer, because I'm not operating around a handcuff.

Officer Biggs looks at the gray, shaking girl on the bed. Then she takes out her key.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 1:21 PM

Tanya under anesthesia, the abdomen open. Lowery and Amond at the table. Kennerly retracts. The smell of bowel contents. Officer Biggs stands outside the doorway in a paper bunny suit, watching through the window.

LOWERY
(calm)
Run the bowel from the ligament of Treitz.

Amond runs the small bowel hand over hand, inch by inch, until he finds it: a loop of terminal ileum, angry and red, with a ragged hole the plastic pen clip has driven through. The battery sits nearby in the lumen.

AMOND
(beat)
There. (beat) Ten centimeters from the valve. Perforation, a centimeter, contamination localized. (beat) The battery's intact. No leakage.

LOWERY
(beat)
Plan?

AMOND
Small-bowel resection, both foreign bodies with it, primary anastomosis. (beat) Copious washout.

LOWERY
(handing him the stapler)
Do it.

Amond fires. The segment comes out: the battery and the clip inside, a piece of bowel the length of a finger. He drops it into a basin. Clang.

KENNERLY
(low)
She'll be back in the Bing in a week.

AMOND
(sewing)
Probably.

KENNERLY
(beat)
And she'll do it again.

AMOND
(beat)
Probably.

Lowery watches him over his mask.

LOWERY
(beat)
Dr. Baker. When you're done, go ask her why.

AMOND
(beat)
I know why. She wants out of the cell.

LOWERY
(beat)
You know what she did. (beat) Go find out why.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SECURITY OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 1:46 PM

Big Ray, at his desk, is feeding the puppy bits of a turkey sandwich. Bernie (55) leans in the doorway. The puppy, warm now, chases a rolled-up glove around the box.

BERNIE
(beat)
Raymond Toles. (beat) Is that a dog?

BIG RAY
(not looking up)
What dog.

BERNIE
(beat)
The dog eating your sandwich.

BIG RAY
(beat)
That's a security consultant.
(beat) Undercover.

Bernie comes in, crouches with surprising grace for a woman in heels, and offers her hand. The puppy licks it, then sneezes.

BERNIE
(softening completely)
Oh, look at her face. (beat)
Whose is she?

BIG RAY
(beat)
Dr. Bullock found her in the snow behind Monty's.

BERNIE
(beat)
Which Dr. Bullock?

BIG RAY
(beat)
The one who's not allowed to have her.

Bernie picks up the puppy and holds her to her face.

BERNIE
(beat)
I didn't see a thing.

BIG RAY
That's what I told him.

21 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - DAY

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 2:04 PM

Clayton, on a snow-day afternoon off, sits on the sofa going over fetal echo printouts. His cell rings. "ESTHER." He answers.

CLAYTON
(into the phone)
Hey.

ESTHER (V.O.)
(on the phone, fast, in a hospital stairwell)
My mother called. (beat) She asked him. (beat) Malcolm.

Clayton puts the printouts down.

CLAYTON
(carefully)
And?

ESTHER (V.O.)
(beat)
He said yes. (beat) Christmas Eve. Mattapan. (beat) He's bringing sweet potato pies from the church ladies at Twelfth Baptist, like he used to. (beat) My mother cried on the phone. (beat) She said, "There won't be an empty chair."

A long silence. Clayton looks at the snow falling past the window onto Remsen Street.

CLAYTON
(finally)
Esther. (beat) Do you want me to stay in New York?

ESTHER (V.O.)
(beat)
No. (beat) I want you to come. (beat) I want you to sit at that table with him and my mother and my four sisters. (beat) And I want to see who flinches first.

CLAYTON
(beat, almost a laugh)
That's not therapy, Esther. That's a duel.

ESTHER (V.O.)
(beat)
It's Mattapan, Clayton. (beat) It's both.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 2:27 PM

Robert reviews Dash's echo at the bedside with Raven. Dash, his line-up fresh, is in a good mood. Robert notices the haircut. He looks at Raven.

ROBERT
(beat)
Mr. Duvall has a new haircut.

DASH
(proudly)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) She's an artist.

ROBERT
(beat)
Dr. Ellison. A word.

In the hallway, out of earshot. Robert speaks quietly.

ROBERT
(beat)
I've been doing this for twenty-three years, Dr. Ellison. (beat) A 1A patient waiting for a heart is the loneliest person in a hospital. (beat) He'll fall in love with the first person who treats him like he isn't dying.

RAVEN
(beat)
I gave him a haircut, Dr. Bullock.

ROBERT
(beat)
I know. (beat) And he looked at you in that mirror like you'd given him a heart. (beat) Be his doctor. (beat) That's the only thing that will help him.

Raven looks back through the doorway. Dash, alone, is studying his reflection in the window glass, touching his hairline, smiling.

RAVEN
(barely)
Yes, sir.

23 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 2:52 PM

The bar, warm against the snow outside. A snow-day crowd of off-shift nurses. Monty (43) behind the bar. Esther and Harmony at the bar with coffees on a quick break. Marc comes in, stamping snow, and sits beside them.

MONTY
(to Marc)
I heard you found a dog behind my dumpster.

MARC
(beat)
How did you...

MONTY
(beat)
Ray's daughter's Biscuit used to sleep under my bar. (beat) Ray called me to ask if she was mine. (beat) She's not. (beat) She's yours now.

HARMONY
(delighted)
We're getting a dog?

MARC
(beat)
I didn't say...

ESTHER
(beat)
You put her inside your coat, Marc. (beat) In the snow. (beat) You said "Hey, little girl." (beat) You've already got a dog.

Marc looks at Esther. She looks back. It's the most natural they've been with each other in months.

HARMONY
What are we naming her?

MONTY
(wiping a glass)
Something with dignity. (beat) She came out of a cardboard box behind a bar in a snowstorm. She deserves a name that sounds like somebody wanted her.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
Mercy.

A beat. Esther smiles into her coffee.

ESTHER
(beat)
Mercy.

HARMONY
(beat)
Mercy Bullock. (beat) Mercy Donohue-Bullock. (beat) She's going to be insufferable.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 6 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:21 PM

Tamika, post-op, pale, an IV in each arm, lies propped up. Andre sits beside her with five Polaroids fanned out on the blanket, one from each isolette. Marc stands at the foot of the bed with Crump.

TAMIKA
(touching each photo)
Aaliyah. (beat) Andre Junior. (beat) Brielle. (beat) Devin. (beat) And Elijah. (beat) We named them in August. Alphabetical. Andre's an accountant.

ANDRE
(smiling weakly)
It's a system.

TAMIKA
(beat, looking at Marc)
You're the one who put the tube in Elijah. (beat) The nurse told me. (beat) You got him breathing.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

TAMIKA
(beat)
Thank you.

Marc looks at Crump. Crump nods once and steps back. Marc comes around and sits on the edge of the bed. Tamika sees his face, and her own face changes.

TAMIKA
(barely)
No.

MARC
(gently)
Mrs. Wardell. (beat) Elijah was born very, very small. Six hundred and eighty grams. (beat) The blood vessels in a baby that small are like wet tissue paper. (beat) When he was born, he had bleeding in his brain. On both sides. It's the most severe kind.

ANDRE
(beat)
What does that mean?

MARC
(beat, holding Tamika's eyes)
It means that we can keep his body going for a while. (beat) But the part of his brain that would let him breathe on his own, and see you, and know you, is very badly damaged. (beat) We don't think he's going to survive. (beat) And if he does, it won't be the life you dreamed for him.

Tamika looks at the fifth Polaroid. Elijah. The smallest.

TAMIKA
(whispering)
Because I said no. (beat) At twelve weeks. (beat) Because I wouldn't reduce.

MARC
(beat, firm)
No, ma'am. (beat) Because he was born at twenty-nine weeks during an abruption, and he was the smallest of five. (beat) You didn't do this. (beat) You gave four of them a chance they wouldn't have had otherwise. (beat) And you gave Elijah a name.

On the monitor at the nurses' station across the unit, an alarm starts to sound. A nurse looks up. Crump turns toward the sound. A NICU nurse appears in the doorway, breathless.

NICU NURSE
Dr. Crump. (beat) Baby E. (beat) He's bradying down.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:26 PM

Isolette E. Alarms. The monitor reads a heart rate of fifty-two, then forty-eight. Crump and the NICU attending work. Marc arrives at a run.

NICU ATTENDING
(fast)
Bradycardic, desaturating. (beat) The tube's in. Breath sounds equal. (beat) His pressure's gone. (beat) Head ultrasound shows the left bleed has extended.

CRUMP
(watching the tiny chest, calm)
Epinephrine?

NICU ATTENDING
(beat)
We can give it, Isaiah. (beat) It'll buy minutes.

Crump looks at the baby for a long moment. Then he looks at Marc.

CRUMP
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Bring his mother. (beat) Now. (beat) Wheel her in the bed if you have to.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, sir.

CRUMP
(to the nurse, gently)
Hand-bag him. Keep him warm. (beat) No more needles. (beat) We're going to let him meet his mother.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:41 PM

Tamika, in a wheelchair with IVs trailing behind her, sits beside isolette E. Andre stands behind her. A nurse lifts Elijah out, wires and all, and lays him in his mother's hands. He weighs less than a can of soda. He's wrapped in a knitted cap and a blanket the size of a dish towel. Marc stands to one side. Crump at the head of the isolette.

TAMIKA
(whispering)
Hi, Elijah. (beat) Hi, baby. (beat) I'm your mama.

Elijah's tiny fist uncurls against her thumb. Andre puts his hand over his wife's.

ANDRE
(barely)
Hey, little man. (beat) E. (beat) Last in the alphabet. (beat) We saved the best for last.

The monitor slows. Forty. Thirty-two. The nurse silences the alarm. Nobody speaks. Tamika rocks him, singing so softly it's barely there. "Jesus Loves Me."

The line on the monitor goes flat. Crump listens with a stethoscope the size of a quarter, for a full minute.

CRUMP
(gently)
Time of death, four-oh-two p.m.

Tamika keeps singing. She doesn't stop.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:19 PM

Marc sits on the stairs between three and four with his head in his hands. The door opens. Elxa comes slowly down the steps, one hand on the rail and one on her belly, and lowers herself onto the step beside him with great effort.

ELXA
(beat)
Four of five, Marc.

MARC
(beat, not looking up)
I intubated him. (beat) I got him breathing. (beat) I got his heart rate up. (beat) And all I did was give him six hours to bleed into his brain.

ELXA
(beat)
You gave his mother six hours to know he existed. (beat) And you gave her the chance to hold him while he was warm.

Marc looks at her.

ELXA
(beat)
My first year. (beat) Twenty-four-weeker. Kingston, Jamaica, born on a plane. (beat) I bagged her for forty minutes in the back of an ambulance on the Van Wyck. (beat) She died in the elevator. (beat) Before her mother ever saw her. (beat) I'd give anything for that mother to have had six hours.

Elxa winces and puts a hand on the side of her belly. Marc sees it.

MARC
(alarmed)
Elx.

ELXA
(beat, half
laughing)
He's kicking. (beat) Hard. (beat)
He does it every time I'm sad.
(beat) I think he's telling me to
get up.

Marc puts his hand on her belly. A kick, right under his palm. His face breaks.

MARC
(barely)
Hey, Nephew.

ELXA
(beat, softly)
Four of five, baby brother.
(beat) Go say goodnight to the
other four.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL WARD - ROOM 418 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:44 PM

Tanya, post-op, drowsy, an NG tube in her nose, cuffed again to the rail by one wrist. Officer Biggs sits in the corner. Amond comes in and stands at the foot of the bed with the chart. He doesn't open it.

AMOND
(beat)
Ms. Harrell. (beat) Why are you
in segregation?

TANYA
(groggy, surprised)
Nobody asks that.

AMOND
I'm asking.

TANYA
(beat)
I'm pretrial. (beat) Petit larceny. Four hundred dollars of baby formula at the Pathmark on Atlantic. (beat) Bail was fifteen hundred. I didn't have it. (beat) That was April.

AMOND
(beat)
And the Bing?

TANYA
(beat, staring at the ceiling)
A girl on my tier took my daughter's letters. (beat) Kiara's six. She writes me on that wide-ruled paper with the dotted line in the middle. (beat) That girl tore them up in front of me. (beat) I broke her nose. (beat) Two hundred and ten days in the Bing.

Amond is silent.

TANYA
(beat)
You've never been in a room by yourself for seven months, Doctor. (beat) Nobody talks to you. Nobody touches you, except to cuff you. (beat) You start hearing your own blood. (beat) Swallowing a battery was the first time in seven months anybody put their hands on me to help.

Amond opens the chart. He uncaps his pen and writes for a long time. Officer Biggs watches him.

AMOND
(finally, to Officer Biggs)
Post-operative patient with a fresh bowel anastomosis and documented self-injury in isolation. (beat) My medical recommendation is that she not return to punitive segregation. (beat) Medical housing at the West Facility, with mental health follow-up. (beat) I'll have Dr. Lowery cosign it.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
Doctors write that all the time, Dr. Baker. (beat) Sometimes the Department listens.

AMOND
(closing the chart)
Then I'll write it again.

Tanya turns her head on the pillow and looks at him.

TANYA
(beat)
You said I was taking a room from somebody who didn't do this to themselves.

AMOND
(beat, at the door)
I was wrong about who did it to you.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:06 PM

Dash dozes. Raven takes his blood pressure. She frowns at the reading. Eighty-eight over fifty. She checks again. Eighty-six. His fingertips are cool. She hesitates, her hand on his wrist, for one beat too long.

DASH
(opening his eyes, seeing her face)
That bad?

RAVEN
(beat)
Eighty-six. (beat) Your feet are cold.

DASH
(beat)
They've been cold since October.

Raven picks up the phone on the wall and dials.

RAVEN
(into the phone, steady)
Dr. Bullock. Ellison. (beat) Duvall's pressure is eighty-six over fifty, down from ninety-eight at three. Cool extremities. (beat) Urine output's down. Thirty cc's the last two hours.

She listens.

RAVEN
(beat)
Yes, sir. (beat) Increase the milrinone to point-five. A bolus of two-fifty. Recheck in thirty minutes. (beat) Yes, sir.

She hangs up and adjusts the pump. Dash watches her.

DASH
(beat)
You paged him.

RAVEN
(beat)
He told me to page him if you dropped below ninety.

DASH
(beat, softly)
He also told you to page him if I asked you out.

RAVEN
(beat, not looking at him)
You didn't ask me out.

DASH
(beat)
I'm working up to it. (beat) I've got a cantaloupe for a heart. It takes me longer.

Raven finishes adjusting the pump and keeps her eyes on the numbers.

RAVEN
(beat)
I'm your doctor, Dash.

DASH
(beat, closing his eyes, smiling)
I know. (beat) That's why I'm still here.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:24 PM

Amond writes notes. Natasha stops beside him, still in her coat, on her way out.

NATASHA
(beat)
Dr. Baker. (beat) Dr. Whitlow has asked if you'd present the Tate case at Medicine Grand Rounds on the twentieth.

Amond stops writing.

AMOND
(beat)
He asked for me?

NATASHA
(beat)
He asked for "the surgeon who caught it." (beat) I'm telling you that it's entirely your choice. (beat) I won't think less of you either way.

AMOND
(beat)
You want me to say no.

NATASHA
(beat)
I want you to do what Dr. Baker would do if he weren't living in my son's house.

Amond thinks about it.

AMOND
(beat)
Tell him yes. (beat) Not for him. (beat) For Mr. Tate's daughter. (beat) She wrote it down and nobody heard her. (beat) Forty-one residents are going to hear her on the twentieth.

NATASHA
(beat, a small smile)
I'll tell him exactly that.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:43 PM

Arianna is packing her review books into her bag. Raven comes in. Arianna doesn't look up.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You paged Bullock for a pressure of eighty-six.

RAVEN
How do you...

ARIANNA
(beat)
I was at the step-down station getting a cardiology consult signed. (beat) I watched you take his pressure twice. (beat) And hold his wrist like you were holding his hand.

RAVEN
(beat)
He's my patient.

ARIANNA
(turning)
Then why did it take you so long to pick up the phone?

Silence.

ARIANNA
(beat, quieter)
I take my boards in three days, Raven. (beat) The thing that decides whether I have a job next year. (beat) And you're standing in a room thinking about a man with a garden hose for a heart.

RAVEN
(beat)
That's not fair.

ARIANNA
(shouldering her bag)
No. (beat) It's not. (beat) But I'm not going to stand here and be fair about it. (beat) I'm going home to study renal.

She walks out. Raven stands alone in the on-call room.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:14 PM

Four isolettes now: A, B, C, D. Isolette E is empty, its card gone. Baby D has a clear plastic silo over his belly now, his bowel inside it, a feeding tube taped to his cheek. Marc stands beside it. Crump comes to stand next to him, his bow tie loosened.

CRUMP
(beat)
Devin's silo went in well. (beat) You held the bowel very gently. (beat) That's rarer than you'd think.

MARC
(beat)
Thank you, sir.

CRUMP
(beat)
You told that young woman the truth today, Dr. Bullock. (beat) Slowly. With your whole face. (beat) You didn't hide behind the numbers.

MARC
(beat)
I didn't know how else to do it.

CRUMP
(beat)
That's the gift. (beat) Most surgeons spend thirty years learning how to say "your baby is going to die" so that it doesn't cost them anything. (beat) It's supposed to cost you something.

They look at the four sleeping babies.

CRUMP
(beat)
I'm sixty-one. (beat) Two more winters, maybe three, and they'll give me a cake in the cafeteria. (beat) When that day comes, somebody has to sit with the mothers. (beat) I'd like it to be somebody who knows them. (beat) Not just their charts.

Marc turns to look at him. Crump straightens his bow tie and walks away.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SECURITY OFFICE - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:41 PM

Big Ray holds the puppy, now asleep on his chest. Marc comes in, in his coat. Big Ray hands her over carefully, like a baby.

BIG RAY
(gruff)
She ate half a turkey sandwich, a granola bar and a corner of the incident log. (beat) She's had two accidents. (beat) One on Bernie's shoe.

MARC
(wincing)
I'm sorry.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Bernie wasn't. (beat) Bernie's been in here four times.

He opens a desk drawer and takes out a worn red leather collar with a brass tag that reads "BISCUIT." He holds it out.

BIG RAY
(beat)
My daughter's in Atlanta now. (beat) She told me to give it to somebody who'd love a pit bull right. (beat) Change the tag.

Marc takes the collar. He fastens it around Mercy's tiny neck. It's much too big. It hangs on her like a necklace.

MARC
(beat)
Thank you, Ray.

BIG RAY
(beat, looking away)
Get her out of here before Dr. Donohue walks by. (beat) And Dr. Bullock. (beat) The puppy's name?

MARC
(beat)
Mercy.

BIG RAY
(beat, a slow smile)
That's a good name for a hospital dog.

34 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:12 PM

The park is buried in snow, untouched. The Manhattan skyline glows across the river through falling flakes. Marc walks slowly with Mercy on a borrowed leash, the puppy hopping through the drifts like a rabbit. Esther walks beside him, her hands in her pockets.

ESTHER
(beat)
Malcolm's coming to Christmas Eve. (beat) In Mattapan. (beat) My mother asked him, and he said yes.

MARC
(beat)
Are you okay with that?

ESTHER
(beat)
I asked her to. (beat) I'm the reason. (beat) So I don't get to not be okay with it.

MARC
(beat)
You get to be whatever you are, Esther.

Mercy stops and sneezes in the snow. They both laugh.

ESTHER
(beat)
You said something to a mother today, didn't you? (beat) I saw your face in the stairwell. (beat) Elxa was holding your hand.

MARC
(beat)
One of the quints died. (beat) The smallest. (beat) I told them.

Esther stops walking. She looks at him, snow in her hair.

ESTHER
(quietly)
You always do that. (beat) Walk toward the worst thing in the room.

MARC
(beat)
You know me.

ESTHER
(beat)
I know you, Marc. (beat) That's never been the problem.

Mercy tugs at the leash. They keep walking toward the water, a careful foot apart.

35 INT. THE DIVINE HOUSE - CAMBRIA HEIGHTS - DINING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:46 PM

A cozy dining room, plastic over the good tablecloth. Lillian (53) sets down a pan of smothered pork chops. Howard (55), at the head of the table, beaming. Jerry and Ronnie (33), twin brothers built like linebackers, flank him. Harmony comes in from the cold, and behind her, nervous, in her Saints jacket, holding a store-bought pie: Camille.

LILLIAN
(bright)
Baby Girl! (beat) And you brought a friend.

Harmony stops in the dining room doorway. Everyone looks at her. She takes Camille's hand.

HARMONY
(beat, steady)
Mama. Daddy. Jerry. Ronnie. (beat) This is Camille Toussaint. (beat) She's an orthopedic surgeon. (beat) She's not my friend. (beat) She's my girlfriend.

A silence. Jerry and Ronnie look at each other. Howard sets down his fork. Camille grips Harmony's hand so hard her knuckles go pale.

LILLIAN
(beat, wiping her hands on a dish towel, completely calm)
I know, Baby Girl. (beat) I've known since you were sixteen and wouldn't let anybody but Alicia Monroe sit next to you in the choir loft. (beat) Sit down. The chops are getting cold.

HOWARD
(beat, laughing, which turns into a cough, which turns back into a laugh)
Camille. (beat) Do you eat pork chops?

CAMILLE
(barely)
Yes, sir.

HOWARD
(beat, pulling out the chair beside him)
Then sit by me. (beat) My daughter got good news today. (beat) I got a June. (beat) And now I've got a surgeon at my table. (beat) Lord, it's been a good day.

Camille sits. She looks at Harmony across the table, her eyes full. Jerry passes her the rolls without a word. Ronnie passes her the greens.

RONNIE
(beat, gruff)
You hurt our sister, we break your femurs.

CAMILLE
(beat, a wet laugh)
Femur's my specialty, Ronnie.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 8:19 PM

Amond rides down. Officer Biggs, in her coat, steps in on four, going off shift. The doors close.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
Dr. Baker. (beat) The captain on the West Facility called back. (beat) Harrell's going to medical housing. Not the Bing. (beat) Thirty days for now.

AMOND
(beat)
Thirty days.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
It's thirty more than she had this morning.

The elevator descends.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat)
My son was in this hospital last week. (beat) Jermaine Biggs. The wing contest. (beat) A Dr. Bullock and a Dr. Lowery saved his life.

AMOND
(beat)
I heard about the wings.

OFFICER BIGGS
(beat, shaking her head)
A hundred and seventy-four. (beat) To pay my light bill. (beat) Doctor, I've worked doubles on Rikers for fourteen years. (beat) I've seen a lot of girls like Harrell. (beat) Most doctors look at them like they're a waste of a bed. (beat) Thank you for looking twice.

The doors open. She steps out into the lobby. Amond stays in the elevator a moment longer before he follows.

37 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:02 PM

Marc comes in with snow on his shoulders and Mercy in his coat. Raven sits alone at the kitchen table with a cup of cold tea. She looks up. Marc unzips his coat. A tiny brindle head with one ear up and one ear down pops out.

RAVEN
(beat, her face transforming)
Oh. (beat) Oh, Marc.

MARC
(setting the puppy on the floor)
Mercy. (beat) She's ours.

Mercy skitters across the kitchen tiles, slips, recovers, and makes straight for Raven. She sits on Raven's foot and looks up at her. Raven picks her up and holds her against her face.

MARC
(beat, sitting down)
Arianna?

RAVEN
(into the puppy's fur)
She's mad at me. (beat) She has a right to be.

MARC
(beat)
Because of the transplant patient.

RAVEN
(beat, looking up, startled)
Does everybody know?

MARC
(beat)
Rave. You gave a man a line-up with clippers you borrowed from the lobby barber. (beat) It's on the blog.

Raven groans and buries her face in the puppy. Mercy licks her ear.

38 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:41 PM

Clayton opens the door. Esther comes in, stamping snow, unwinding her scarf. It's covered in brindle dog hair. Clayton looks at it.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You have dog hair on your scarf.

ESTHER
(beat)
A puppy. (beat) In the snow behind Monty's. (beat) Ten weeks. (beat) She was freezing.

CLAYTON
(beat, carefully)
Whose puppy is she now?

Esther hangs the scarf on the hook. A long beat.

ESTHER
(beat)
Marc's. (beat) He named her Mercy.

Clayton nods slowly. He picks a single dog hair off her coat sleeve and studies it.

CLAYTON
(beat, lightly)
We should get a dog. (beat) Someday. (beat) When we have a yard.

ESTHER
(beat, not quite meeting his eyes)
Someday.

39 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:33 PM

Arianna at her small desk, surrounded by renal flashcards, the snow piling up on the window ledge. Her phone buzzes. "RAVEN." She doesn't answer. It stops. Then a text appears.

SMS: "k."

Arianna stares at it. Then, in spite of herself, the corner of her mouth twitches. She picks up the next flashcard. It's purple.

TAG

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:31 PM

The unit is dim. Dash lies awake in the blue light of the monitor, his pressure back up to ninety-four. Through the window, the snow falls over Queens. The night nurse passes. Behind her, coming off a late shift with her coat over her arm, Raven pauses at his door.

DASH
(softly, not turning his head)
Night, Dr. Ellison.

RAVEN
(beat)
Night, Dash.

She keeps walking. He smiles at the ceiling and touches his fresh hairline.

MARC (V.O.)
Doctors are supposed to know people.

41 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, DECEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:57 PM

Marc in bed in the dark. Mercy, in Biscuit's too-big red collar, is curled into a tight ball on his chest, rising and falling with his breathing. Outside, the snow is still falling.

MARC (V.O.)
We learn their organs. Their numbers. Their blood types and their bleeding times.

Marc rests his hand on the sleeping puppy.

MARC (V.O.)
But a woman in a cell, a man waiting for a heart, a mother singing to a baby the size of her hand... (beat) Nobody knows any of them until they ask.

Mercy sighs in her sleep. Marc closes his eyes.

MARC (V.O.)
And by the time most of us think to ask, they've already stopped hoping anyone will.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x11

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: "LET IT SNOW!"

Friday, December 9, 2005

"The first big snowstorm of the season blanketed the city today, snarling the morning commute and sending slips, falls and fender-benders into emergency rooms across the five boroughs..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "JET SKIDS OFF SNOWY CHICAGO RUNWAY, KILLING BOY IN CAR"

Thursday, December 8, 2005

"CHICAGO (AP) -- A Southwest Airlines jet landing in heavy snow at Midway Airport skidded off the runway, through a fence and into a street, striking cars and killing a 6-year-old boy..." Also: federal air marshals shot and killed a passenger at Miami International Airport on Wednesday after he said he had a bomb; no bomb was found.

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Friday, December 9, 2005, 4:40 PM

"SNOW DAY AT THE GRACE. Five babies were born in OR 2 this morning, QUINTUPLETS, at 29 weeks. We're told the smallest didn't make it this afternoon, and we're not going to say anything else about that except that we're so sorry. In other news: an intern borrowed the lobby barber's clippers to give a transplant patient a line-up. Our source says he looks 'like a whole new man.' Also, we cannot confirm a puppy in the security office. We CAN confirm Bernie's shoe." Comments (1,118).

Jamaica Hospital Medical Center: CT Chest Report (excerpt), patient Howard Divine

Read Thursday, December 8, 2005

"IMPRESSION: 6 mm solid noncalcified nodule, right upper lobe, smooth margins, unchanged in size compared with the chest radiograph of 9/6/2005. No mediastinal or hilar lymphadenopathy. RECOMMENDATION: Follow-up CT in 6 months."

Medical recommendation, Dr. Amond Baker (cosigned by Dr. A. Lowery)

Friday, December 9, 2005

"Patient is POD 0 following small bowel resection for foreign-body perforation, with documented self-injury in punitive segregation. Medically recommend against return to punitive segregation. Recommend medical housing with mental health follow-up."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison to Arianna Cummings)

Friday, December 9, 2005, 10:33 PM

Raven: "k."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x11

New Canon Established

- **DASH DUVALL'S DEBUT** (34): idiopathic dilated cardiomyopathy, EF 15%, Status 1A since November 11, 2005, on continuous milrinone through a PICC, in Cardiac Step-Down Room 609. He owns two sneaker stores in Charlotte. He came to New York for a sneaker convention at the Javits Center in October, collapsed there, and 'never made it home.' **Raven gave him a line-up** with the lobby barber's clippers. Robert warned her: 'Be his doctor.' His pressure dropped to 86 and she paged Robert, but hesitated first. Dash: 'I'm working up to [asking you out].' This begins the R-5 storyline.
- **Arianna and Raven fought** over Dash: 'Why did it take you so long to pick up the phone?' Arianna's Step 2 CK retake is Monday, December 12. That night Raven texted 'k.' and Arianna almost smiled.
- **The Wardell quintuplets** were born at 29w2d by crash cesarean for abruption (Hartwell). Five neonatal teams worked them (Crump; Elxa with Arianna; two NICU fellows; Marc). **Marc intubated Baby E, Elijah (680 g)**, who had bilateral grade III/IV intraventricular hemorrhage. Marc told the parents himself. Elijah died in his mother's arms at 4:02 PM; Crump called it. **Four of five survive:** Aaliyah, Andre Jr., Brielle and Devin (gastroschisis, silo placed by Crump with Marc). Tamika had refused selective reduction at 12 weeks and blamed herself. Crump told Marc he wants someone 'who knows the mothers' to succeed him: 'Two more winters, maybe three.'
- **Tanya Harrell** (29) is a Rikers pretrial detainee held since April on a $1,500 bail she can't pay, for $400 of baby formula. She spent 210 days in punitive segregation ('the Bing') for breaking the nose of a woman who tore up her daughter Kiara's letters. She swallowed two AA batteries and a pen clip; one battery came out by endoscopy, and the pen clip perforated her ileum (resection by Lowery and Baker). **Amond went from 'I don't think about her' to writing a medical recommendation against segregation**, and she got 30 days of medical housing. Kennerly challenged him, and Lowery: 'Go find out why.'
- **MERCY THE DOG:** a brindle pit bull puppy (about 10 weeks old, one ear up, one down), found by **Marc and Esther together** in a box behind Monty's dumpster at 6:34 AM. Big Ray kept her under his desk all day. Bernie is smitten. She wears the red leather collar of Big Ray's late dog Biscuit (his daughter lives in Atlanta). Marc named her at Monty's. She lives at 49th Avenue, and Esther now has dog hair on her scarf. Clayton: 'We should get a dog. Someday.'
- **Howard Divine's CT** (read December 8): 6 mm solid RUL nodule, unchanged since September, no nodes; repeat CT in June 2006. 'My daddy's got a June.' **Harmony introduced Camille to her family as 'my girlfriend.'** Lillian: 'I know, Baby Girl.' Howard welcomed her. Ronnie: 'You hurt our sister, we break your femurs.' This is the opposite of Augustin's rejection.
- **Malcolm accepted Corinne's invitation** to Christmas Eve in Mattapan; he'll bring sweet potato pies from the Twelfth Baptist church ladies. Esther wants Clayton there: 'It's Mattapan, Clayton. It's both.'
- **Whitlow asked for Amond** to present the Tate case at Medicine Grand Rounds on December 20, ahead of the January 15 Evidence of Standards Compliance deadline. Amond agreed 'for Mr.

Tate's daughter.' Officer Biggs thanked Amond 'for looking twice.' Her son Jermaine is recovering. Elxa told Marc about her first-year neonatal death (a 24-weeker, in an ambulance on the Van Wyck).

Knowledge Tracker (as of December 9, 2005)

Item	Who knows
Raven's feelings for Dash	Raven (denying), Dash, Robert (suspects), Arianna, Marc, the blog
Mercy the dog	The housemates, Esther, Clayton, Big Ray, Bernie, Monty; Natasha 'has not been told'
Harmony and Camille	The Divine family now knows; Augustin knows and rejects it
Howard's nodule (stable)	The Divines, Camille
Heir designation	Still secret

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Tanya Harrell	5/3/1976 (29)	Ingested 2 AA batteries and a pen clip; ileal perforation	EGD retrieval; small bowel resection (Lowery; Baker; Kennerly)	Recovering; medical housing
Tamika Wardell	9/14/1974 (31)	Quintuplets at 29w2d, placental abruption	Crash cesarean (Hartwell)	Stable
Wardell A, B, C	12/9/2005	Prematurity (1,100 / 1,200 / 1,000 g)	Resuscitation; CPAP (Crump; Elxa, Cummings)	Stable in NICU
Wardell D (Devin)	12/9/2005	Prematurity, 950 g; gastroschisis	Silo placement (Crump; Bullock)	Stable
Wardell E (Elijah)	12/9/2005	Prematurity, 680 g; bilateral grade III/IV IVH	Intubation and surfactant (Bullock); comfort care	Died at 4:02 PM
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	Idiopathic DCM, EF 15%, Status 1A; hypotension to 86	Milrinone increased (R. Bullock; Ellison)	Recovered to 94 systolic; waiting for a heart

New Characters

- **Darius 'Dash' Duvall** (b. August 8, 1971), debut (in MA-005). **Tanya Harrell** (b. May 3, 1976) and her daughter **Kiara** (6, mentioned). **Tamika Wardell** (b. September 14, 1974), a third-grade teacher, and **Andre Wardell** (b. March 27, 1972), an accountant, with their quintuplets, born December 9, 2005.
- **Mercy**, a pit bull puppy (estimated birth late September 2005). Jerry and Ronnie Divine appear on screen.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- The first significant snowstorm of the 2005-06 winter hit New York on Friday, December 9, 2005. On December 8, 2005, Southwest Airlines Flight 1248 overran a snowy runway at

Chicago Midway and struck cars, killing a 6-year-old boy. On December 7, 2005, federal air marshals shot a passenger at Miami International Airport. Rikers Island's women's jail is the Rose M. Singer Center, and punitive segregation is known among detainees as 'the Bing.' Twelfth Baptist Church is in Roxbury.

- Medicine: most cylindrical batteries in the stomach pass or can be retrieved endoscopically, and sharp objects can perforate the bowel near the ileocecal valve. Higher-order multiples at 29 weeks need one resuscitation team per infant. Infants under 750 g have high rates of severe intraventricular hemorrhage, and grade IV IVH carries a grave prognosis. Gastroschisis is managed with a preformed silo and staged reduction. Status 1A heart transplant candidates are often inpatients on continuous inotropes such as milrinone.